

Cheng Xu

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Trustworthy AI, NLP, LLMs Evaluation, Benchmark Data Contamination, Fake News Detection

EDUCATION	University College Dublin , Dublin, Ireland Ph.D., Computer Science Supervisor: Prof. M-Tahar Kechadi Thesis: Trustworthy Evaluation of Large Language Models: Benchmark Data Contamination and Defense Sep 2022 - Aug 2026 (Expected)
	Huaibei Normal University , Huaibei, P.R. China B.Eng., Data Science and Big Data Technology Mentor: Prof. Qi Fan & Prof. Longfeng Shen Graduated with Provincial Honor (Highest for graduates) Sep 2018 - Jun 2022

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS *Full list of publications on [Google Scholar](#).
* indicates corresponding author; † indicates co-first authorship, ‡ indicates a student I mentored.*

Selected First-Authored Publications

- [5] **Cheng Xu**, Nan Yan, Shuhao Guan, Yuke Mei, M-Tahar Kechadi. [SSA: Semantic Contamination of LLM-Driven Fake News Detection](#) (*EMNLP 2025*)
- [4] **Cheng Xu**, Nan Yan, Shuhao Guan, Changhong Jin, Yuke Mei, Yibing Guo, M-Tahar Kechadi. [DCR: Quantifying Data Contamination in LLMs Evaluation](#) (*EMNLP 2025*)
- [3] **Cheng Xu**, Nan Yan. [TripleFact: Defending Data Contamination in the Evaluation of LLM-driven Fake News Detection](#) (*ACL 2025*)
- [2] **Cheng Xu**, M-Tahar Kechadi. Analysis of Semantic Benchmark Data Contamination Attack for LLM-Driven Fake News Detection (*IEEE BigData 2025*)
- [1] **Cheng Xu**^{*}, Shuhao Guan, Derek Greene, M-Tahar Kechadi. [Benchmark Data Contamination of Large Language Models: A Survey](#) (*arXiv:2406.04244, Under Review at ACM CSUR*)

Other Publications

- [7] Shuhao Guan, Moule Lin, **Cheng Xu**, Jinman Zhao, Derek Greene. [Teaching LLMs to Admit Uncertainty in OCR](#) (*ICLR 2026*)
- [6] Shuhao Guan, Moule Lin, **Cheng Xu**, Xinyi Liu, Jinman Zhao, Jiexin Fan, Qi Xu, Derek Greene. [PreP-OCR: A Complete Pipeline for Document Image Restoration and Enhanced OCR Accuracy](#) (*ACL 2025*)
- [5] Shuhao Guan, **Cheng Xu**, Moule Lin, Derek Greene. [Effective Synthetic Data and Test-Time Adaptation for OCR Correction](#) (*EMNLP 2024*)
- [4] Yang Fan[†], **Cheng Xu**^{*}, Shuhao Guan, Nan Yan, Yuke Mei. [Advancing Arabic Sentiment Analysis: ArSen Benchmark and the Improved Fuzzy Deep Hybrid Network](#) (*CoNLL 2024*)
- [3] **Cheng Xu**, M-Tahar Kechadi. [An Enhanced Fake News Detection System with Fuzzy Deep Learning](#) (*IEEE Access, 2024*)
- [2] **Cheng Xu**, Jing Wang, Tianlong Zheng, Yue Cao, Fan Ye. [Prediction of prognosis and survival of patients with gastric cancer by a weighted improved random forest model: an application of machine learning in medicine](#) (*Archives of Medical Science, 2022*)
- [1] **Cheng Xu**, Qingling Chen, Fan Ye, Qi Fan, Qing Wang. [Selection of surgical procedures and analysis of prognostic factors in patients with primary gastric tumour based on Cox regression: a SEER database analysis based on data mining](#) (*Gastroenterology Review, 2021*)

GRANTS & AWARDS	Selected Recipient, OpenAI Research Access Program (2025-2026)
	Selected Recipient, Tinker Research Grant (2025-2026)
	Principal Investigator, National Undergraduate Innovation Training Program of China (2020-2022)

HONORS	IEEE BigData 2025 Travel Award , IEEE	2025
	Graduate with Honor of Anhui Province (Top 3%) , Anhui Province Government	2022
	“Top 100 Outstanding College Students” honorary title, Anhui Province Government	2021
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Ph.D. Researcher , Insight SFI Research Centre for Data Analytics	Sep 2022 - Present
	- Secured research funding as PI from OpenAI and Tinker Research. - Authored a comprehensive survey on benchmark data contamination in LLMs (100+ citations), establishing a foundational reference for the research community. - Proposed novel contamination defense methods (TripleFact, SSA, DCR) for evaluating LLM-driven systems, published as 3 first-authored papers at ACL and EMNLP. - Mentored junior researchers, resulting in co-authored publications at CoNLL 2024 and AfricaNLP.	
	Research Assistant , Data Mining Lab of Huaibei Normal University	Nov 2018 - Oct 2021
	- Applied machine learning techniques to cancer prognosis prediction using SEER database, resulting in 2 journal publications (40+ citations). - Led a nationally funded undergraduate research project (National Innovation Training Program) as PI.	
TEACHING	TA/Demonstrator , University College Dublin	Sep 2023 – Present
	Responsibilities: Lead or assist with lab work, graded assignments, supported students in learning activities for the following modules: - COMP40370 Data Mining (2023 Fall, 2024 Fall, 2025 Fall) - COMP41780 Foundations of Deep Learning (2025 Fall) - COMP41830 Advanced Generative AI & LLMS (2026 Spring) - COMP47590 Advanced Machine Learning (2024 Spring, 2026 Spring) - COMP47650 Deep Learning (2024 Spring, 2025 Spring, 2026 Spring) - COMP47980 Generative AI: Language Models (2024 Spring, 2025 Spring) Additionally served as TA/Demonstrator for 10+ undergraduate and graduate courses in CS.	
ACADEMIC SERVICE	Conference Reviewer : NeurIPS, ICLR, ICML, AAAI, AISTATS	
	Journal Reviewer : IEEE TIFS, Archives of Medical Science	